

ServiceNow Project Notes

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Platform: ServiceNow | Tool: Flow Designer

Purpose: Automate the Standard Laptop procurement process by creating a Catalog Task after the request is approved and assigning it to the Hardware group.

Contents

- 1. Project Background and Objectives
- 2. Milestone 1 - Create the Flow
- 3. Configure the Service Catalog Trigger
- 4. Configure Create Catalog Task Action
- 5. Save and Activate the Flow
- 6. Milestone 2 - Assign Flow to Standard Laptop
- 7. Milestone 3 - Place the Service Catalog Order
- 8. Approval and Requested Item Verification
- 9. Catalog Task Verification
- 10. Complete Workflow and Important Values

1. Project Background

The project is designed to streamline IT procurement for standard laptops. In a manual process, a user places a laptop request and the IT team may need to create and assign a task manually. This can cause delays, repeated work, and mistakes.

The Flow Designer solution connects the Service Catalog request with an automated Catalog Task. Once the relevant request reaches the required approval state, the flow creates a task with the required description and assigns it to the Hardware team.

User Story

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want standard laptop requests to automatically generate a task for the Hardware team so that laptops can be configured promptly and manual intervention is reduced.

Project Objectives

- Provide a smooth experience for users requesting standard laptops.
- Create the required configuration task automatically.
- Reduce manual intervention and possible procurement errors.
- Improve allocation of IT resources.
- Increase efficiency and productivity in procurement operations.

Expected End Result

A user orders Standard Laptop → the Service Catalog request is processed → the request is approved → Flow Designer creates a Catalog Task → the task is assigned to Hardware → the task contains the required short description and approval value.

Key ServiceNow Components Used

Component	Purpose
Service Catalog	User-facing area where the Standard Laptop is ordered.
Flow Designer	Creates the automation workflow.
Service Catalog Trigger	Starts the flow for the catalog request.
Create Catalog Task	Creates the task automatically.
Requested Item	Provides the request item record used by the task.
Assignment Group	Routes the task to the Hardware team.

2. Milestone 1 - Create the Flow

The first milestone is to create a Flow Designer flow named Standard Laptop task.

Step A - Open Flow Designer

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click All in the application navigator.
3. Search for Flow Designer.
4. Open Flow Designer under Process Automation.
5. From Flow Designer, click New and select Flow.

Step B - Enter Flow Properties

The Flow Properties window contains the basic details of the new flow.

Field	Value
Flow name	Standard Laptop task
Description	A suitable description of the laptop automation can be entered.
Application	Global
Protection	Leave as default / None unless the task requires another value.
Run As	System User

1. Check the flow name and settings.
2. Click Submit.
3. The new flow opens in Flow Designer.

Why these settings matter

The name makes the flow easy to identify later. The Global application allows the flow to be used in the intended global configuration. Running as System User allows the automation to perform the required ServiceNow actions.

3. Configure the Service Catalog Trigger

A trigger tells Flow Designer when the automation should start. The task document specifies the Service Catalog trigger.

Trigger Configuration

1. Inside the Standard Laptop task flow, click Add a Trigger.
2. Open the trigger selection field.
3. Search for Service Catalog.
4. Select the Service Catalog trigger.
5. Review the trigger configuration.
6. Click Done.

Trigger Concept

The Service Catalog trigger connects the flow to a catalog request. In simple terms, it tells the system: when the relevant catalog request event occurs, start this flow.

Checkpoint

- Flow name should show: Standard Laptop task.
- Trigger should show: Service Catalog.
- Trigger section should be saved with Done.
- The Actions section should now be ready for the next step.

Common navigation path

All → Flow Designer → Standard Laptop task → Add a Trigger → Service Catalog → Done

Important

Do not create a different trigger unless the task instructions require it. The provided project pages specifically use the Service Catalog trigger.

4. Configure the Create Catalog Task Action

After the trigger, the flow needs an action. The required action is Create Catalog Task.

Step A - Add the Action

1. Go to the Actions section.
2. Click Add an Action.
3. Search for Create Catalog Task.
4. Select Create Catalog Task from the ServiceNow Core actions.

Step B - Configure the Action

1. For the Requested Item Record, drag and drop the Requested Item Record data pill from the request item.
2. The Catalog Task table should be populated automatically.
3. Set the short description to Laptop need to Configured.
4. Use Add field value to add/select the Description field.
5. Set Description to Laptop need to Configured.
6. Add/select the Assignment group field.
7. Set Assignment group to Hardware.
8. Add/select the Approval field.
9. Set Approval to Approved.
10. Leave the remaining fields at their default values unless the task specifically asks you to change them.
11. Click Done.

Required Action Values

Action field	Required value
Action	Create Catalog Task
Requested Item Record	Requested Item Record data pill
Short description	Laptop need to Configured
Description	Laptop need to Configured
Assignment group	Hardware
Approval	Approved

5. Save and Activate the Flow

Once the trigger and action are configured, the flow must be saved and activated.

1. Review the Trigger section.
2. Review the Create Catalog Task action.
3. Confirm the requested item data pill is present.
4. Confirm the short description and description values.
5. Confirm Assignment group = Hardware.
6. Confirm Approval = Approved.
7. Click Save.
8. Click Activate.
9. A confirmation message asks whether you want to activate the flow.
10. Click Activate again to confirm.

Activation Result

The flow should show an Active status. The automation will run when the trigger conditions are met.

Troubleshooting Checklist

- If Activate is unavailable, first make sure the flow has been saved.
- If the action shows an error, check that the Requested Item Record data pill was selected.
- If Hardware is missing, check the Assignment group field value.
- If the flow is inactive after activation, reopen it and verify the activation status.
- Use the exact flow name Standard Laptop task when attaching it to the catalog item.

6. Milestone 2 - Assign the Flow to Standard Laptop

The second milestone connects the flow to the Standard Laptop service catalog item.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click All.
3. Search for Maintain Items.
4. Open Maintain Items.
5. In the Name field, search for Standard Laptop.
6. Open the Standard Laptop catalog item record.
7. Open the Process Engine tab/section.
8. Review the automation settings.
9. Remove remaining automation entries if the task instructions require them to be removed.
10. Add the flow created earlier.
11. Select Standard Laptop task.
12. Save/update the catalog item.

Expected Process Engine Setup

Field	Expected value
Catalog Item	Standard Laptop
Process Engine / Flow	Standard Laptop task
Flow status	Active

Save the catalog item after selecting the flow. This completes the flow assignment portion of the project.

7. Milestone 3 - Place the Service Catalog Order

This milestone tests whether the configured automation works from the user-facing Service Catalog.

1. Click All.
2. Search for Service Catalog.
3. Open Service Catalog.
4. Open the Hardware category.
5. Scroll and find Standard Laptop.
6. Open the Standard Laptop item.
7. Review the item information and available options.
8. Click Order Now.
9. Submit/place the request.

Order Status

1. After placing the order, the Order Status/request confirmation page appears.
2. Find the Request Number.
3. Click the Request Number to open the request record.

Why this step is important

The request is the real test input for the Flow Designer automation. The next steps check whether the approval record and the automatically created Catalog Task appear correctly.

8. Approval and Requested Item Verification

After opening the request record, the task instructions direct you to the Approvers section.

Step A - Open the Approver Record

1. Scroll down to the Approvers section.
2. Locate the approval record for the request.
3. Right-click the approval record.
4. Choose Approve.

Step B - Open the Requested Item

1. After approval, locate the Requested Item section.
2. Open the relevant Requested Item record.
3. Review the record details.

What approval does in this project

The project uses the approval state as part of the business process. Once the request reaches the approved state, the configured automation can create the Catalog Task with the required values.

Verification Point

- Request record is available.
- Approver record is visible.
- Approval can be set to Approved.
- Requested Item record can be opened.
- Catalog Tasks section can be accessed from the Requested Item.

9. Verify the Catalog Task

The final technical verification is to confirm that Flow Designer created the Catalog Task correctly.

1. Open the Requested Item record.
2. Scroll down to the Catalog Tasks section.
3. Locate the Catalog Task created by the flow.
4. Open the task record.
5. Check the task status and details.
6. Verify the short description.
7. Verify the assignment group.
8. Verify the approval value.

Expected Catalog Task Values

Field	Expected result
Catalog Task	A task record is automatically created.
Short description	Laptop need to Configured
Description	Laptop need to Configured
Assignment group	Hardware
Approval	Approved
Requested Item	Linked to the original Requested Item

Final Verification Statement

If the Catalog Task is present and shows the required short description, Hardware assignment group, and Approved value, the main automation objective has been demonstrated.

10. Complete Workflow - Quick Reference

Use this page as a quick revision/checklist while performing the project.

No.	Stage	Action / Value
1	Create Flow	Flow Designer → New → Flow
2	Flow Properties	Name = Standard Laptop task; Application = Global; Run As = System User
3	Trigger	Service Catalog
4	Action	Create Catalog Task
5	Requested Item	Drag Requested Item Record data pill
6	Task Description	Laptop need to Configured
7	Assignment	Hardware
8	Approval	Approved
9	Save	Save the flow
10	Activate	Activate and confirm
11	Assign Flow	Maintain Items → Standard Laptop → Process Engine
12	Test	Service Catalog → Hardware → Standard Laptop → Order Now
13	Approve	Request → Approvers → Approve
14	Verify	Requested Item → Catalog Tasks → Open task

Important Values - Memorize

Flow: Standard Laptop task | Trigger: Service Catalog | Action: Create Catalog Task

Short Description: Laptop need to Configured | Assignment Group: Hardware | Approval: Approved

Project Outcome

The completed solution automates the creation and assignment of a Catalog Task for a Standard Laptop request. It connects the Service Catalog, Flow Designer, approval process, Requested Item, and Hardware assignment into one workflow.

GitHub Documentation Tip

This PDF can be uploaded to your GitHub repository as project documentation. A suitable filename is ServiceNow_Standard_Laptop_Flow_Designer_Notes.pdf. You can also keep a README file with the project title, objective, tools used, workflow, and result.

Request: REQ0010001

Short description: [text area]

Special instructions: [text area]

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links

Show Workflow

Show Workflow Context

Requested Items (0) Approver (0) Resolving Issues (0)

State Search Actions on selected rows... Edit

Approved for: REQ0010001

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Requested	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:07:12

1 to 1 of 1

9. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links

Show Workflow

Show Workflow Context

Requested Items (0) Approver (0) Resolving Issues (0)

State Search Actions on selected rows... Edit

Approved for: REQ0010001

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Requested	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:07:12

1 to 1 of 1

10. Then click on the Requested item Section

11. Open that Requested Item record

Requested Item: RTM0010001

Activity 1

System Administrator

History changes: 2024-04-17 04:07:12

Input: 3 - Low

Open priority: System Administrator

Priority: 4 - Low

Status: Open

Update Delete

Related Links

Show Context

Catalog Tasks (0) Approver Group approvals

Number Search Actions on selected rows... New

Requested Items: RTM0010001

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SC1A00000001	Hardware	[empty]	Laptop needs to be Configured	2024-04-17 04:11:40	[empty]	

1 to 1 of 1

9/11



12. Scroll down to the "Catalog tasks" Section

13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

Creating Task: SC1A00000001

Number: SC1A00000001

Assigned to: [text area]

Configurations: [text area]

Active: ☒

Approval: Approved

Priority: 4 - Low

Status: Open

Requested item: RTM0010001

Requested for: System Administrator

Short description: Laptop needs to be Configured

Description: Laptop needs to be Configured

10. Then click on the Requested item Section

11. Open that Requested Item record

Requested Item: RITM0010001

Impact: Low
Priority: Low
State: Open

Related Links
Catalog Tasks

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	[empty]	Laptop needs to be Configured	2024-04-17 04:13:40	[empty]	



12. Scroll down to the "Catalog tasks" Section

13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

Catalog Task: SCTASK0010001

Number: SCTASK0010001
Approval: Approved
Priority: Low
State: Open
Short description: Laptop needs to be Configured
Assigned to: Hardware

Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.

